

Balance Patch — Change JSON from Evidence

Day 11

Lesson 11

Nora XIE

Course 02

Phase 2 — Data Lab

Time: 60–75 min

Mode: Self-study

Today's goals:

- ★ Link a chart or stat to one game change
- ★ Edit bosses.json with a reason note
- ★ Playtest after the patch



Course 02 quest map: Day 11 of 18

Hook

Pro designers ship patches. You have data — now nerf the dragon or buff poison.

Learn



Learn

Write a **balance note** before changing JSON:

1. Observation: “Poison used only 1 time in 20 fights.”
2. Hypothesis: “Poison too weak or too rare.”
3. Change: increase damage or uses.
4. Test: play 5 rounds again.



AI rules today

Predict/Run: AI off. **Investigate:** Socratic hints only. **Make:** you review every line.

Predict — Run — Investigate — Modify —> Make



Demo code

Folder: day11/

Open: day11/demos/BALANCE_EXAMPLE.md

 Try it

Read `demos/BALANCE_EXAMPLE.md`. Write your own observation from Day 9–10 before coding.

 Assignment

Work in: `day11/assignment/`

A — Written One stat from your report that worried you.

B — Hypothesis If we change X, players will Y.

C — Level up Update `assignment/bosses.json` + `BALANCE_NOTES.md` with before/after stats plan.

D — Playtest 5 fights after patch. Did it feel fairer?

 Checklist

- ☐ Re-read **Learn**; predict outputs (10 min)
- ☐ Assignments A–D (35–45 min)
- ☐ Run your program 3 times with different inputs
- ☐ Stuck 15 min → C-R-A-V (`../shared/prompts.md`)

Reflection

1. Easiest part today?
2. One line you can teach a friend.

Tomorrow: Midterm tomorrow: clean a new messy dataset.